



Figure 1: Calibre Main Window



Figure 2: The 'Connect/Share' feature



Figure 3: It's green! Our server is up.

1. The main toolbar.
2. The Category pane on the left.
3. The e-book listing pane in the centre.
4. The e-book cover preview pane on the right.

All primary functions like adding e-books, converting and viewing them, is done via the main toolbar. The Category pane allows us to control what we see in the listing pane. For example, if you want to see e-books only from the 'Chicken Soup for the Soul' series, you can do so by selecting that particular series name from the 'Series' node in the tree that resides in the category pane. Clicking on a book brings up its cover preview, along with the author's name, format and path in the preview pane.

Calibre has an inbuilt e-book reader that reads all formats. Double-clicking on a book opens it. You can also choose 'View' from the main toolbar. Editing e-book meta-data is also very simple. Just select the book, click the field (example: 'author') and hit F2—just like you would to rename a file. Edit the field and hit 'Enter' to save the changes. The moment you make the change, Calibre will re-organise your library at the back-end (i.e., it will automatically make changes to your library's folder structure). Neat, isn't it?

You may also tag and rate your titles, so that searching and sorting become cooler. Spend some time playing around, and I'm sure you would grow to like it a lot. I cannot imagine how I ever managed my e-book collection without this super tool.

The content server

It is not just local management that Calibre is good at. It is versatile enough to become a content server too! Let's suppose you want to



Figure 4: The Calibre library portal

share your library on your network, so that you can read books on any PC that's hooked up—or say you want to read them over Wi-Fi. Wouldn't that be cool? It's very easy to do this:

1. On the main toolbar, hit the 'Connect/Share' button (Figure 2).
2. Select 'Start Content Server'.
3. Wait a few moments, and the three blue orbs on the button will turn green (Figure 3)—this means that your content server is running.

We can now access the library portal via the URL `http://<hostname>:8080/`. (Replace <hostname> with the IP address/hostname of the PC on which the Calibre server is running; 8080 is the default port on which the content server runs.) To access it from the same PC as the Calibre server, use `http://localhost:8080/`. The portal's home page looks like what is shown in Figure 4. Now you can access your entire library over the network! Isn't it cool?

The best part about this software is that we can continue hoarding our e-books, without worrying about searching through and manually organising them. Or, as they say, we can now 'Tag 'em and bag 'em'. Calibre has saved the day. **END** 

Links

Calibre Home: <http://calibre-ebook.com/>

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